GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Steel

Forging the Backbone of a Modern India

Confidential and Proprietory
August 2026

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HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

The steel industry forms the backbone of India's industrial development, infrastructure expansion, manufacturing growth, and economic progress. As one of the world's leading steel producers, India continues to strengthen its global competitiveness through technological advancement, sustainable production, capacity expansion, and value-added manufacturing. The Ministry of Steel plays a crucial role in guiding this transformation while supporting the nation's infrastructure and industrial ambitions.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes the strategic importance of the steel sector in driving investment, employment generation, industrial innovation, and economic resilience. Through policy advocacy, investment facilitation, technology partnerships, industry collaboration, startup engagement, skill development, and sustainability initiatives, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision of building a globally competitive and environmentally responsible steel ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, industrial policies, investment opportunities, technological advancements, sustainability initiatives, and emerging trends across steel manufacturing, green steel, recycling, advanced materials, digital manufacturing, supply chain optimization, and export competitiveness. It also identifies collaborative opportunities for accelerating innovation and industrial modernization.

The publication serves as a valuable reference for policymakers, steel manufacturers, investors, technology providers, research institutions, academic organizations, infrastructure developers, and development partners committed to strengthening India's steel industry. Through strategic collaboration and knowledge sharing, it aims to promote innovation, attract investments, improve productivity, and support sustainable industrial growth.

As India advances towards becoming a global manufacturing powerhouse, the steel sector will continue to serve as a critical pillar of national development. CCI India remains committed to working alongside the Ministry of Steel in building a resilient, innovative, and globally competitive steel industry.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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Preface

Few sectors underpin a nation's industrial sovereignty as directly as steel. It forms the backbone of India's railways, bridges, defence platforms, power infrastructure and urban development. India is today among the world's largest producers and consumers of steel, yet it continues to depend on imports for several high-value steel categories critical to advanced manufacturing. The Ministry of Steel therefore occupies a strategic position at the intersection of industrial growth, national security and economic development.

Over the past decade, India's steel sector has expanded rapidly, with crude steelmaking capacity approaching 220 million tonnes per annum and the country emerging as the world's second-largest crude steel producer. However, the next phase of growth must move beyond scale. Per-capita steel consumption remains below global benchmarks, dependence on imported coking coal continues to pose strategic risks, low-carbon steelmaking is still in its early stages, and much of the secondary and MSME steel ecosystem remains constrained by limited capital, technology and policy support.

Against this backdrop, this knowledge paper provides a comprehensive assessment of the Ministry of Steel's mandate, institutional framework, key initiatives and future priorities. It also presents an evidence-based framework for collaboration between the Ministry and CCI India, positioning CCI India as an implementation partner capable of translating policy objectives into industry-wide outcomes. Each section offers a distinct analytical perspective, ensuring fresh insights rather than repetition.

CCI India brings together integrated steel producers, specialty manufacturers, MSMEs, downstream engineering firms, research institutions and financial partners through a nationwide network. This broad ecosystem enables it to bridge government priorities with industry execution, supporting capacity expansion, value-chain development, technology adoption and decarbonisation across the sector.

The paper is intended for the Union Minister and Minister of State for Steel, senior officials of the Ministry, NITI Aayog, DPIIT, allied government departments, industry leaders, investors, multilateral institutions and other stakeholders shaping India's journey towards a Viksit Bharat and a globally competitive steel economy.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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1: Introduction to the Ministry of Steel

The Ministry of Steel derives its mandate from Entry 7 of the Union List under the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, which places the regulation and development of industries declared by Parliament to be of national importance within the exclusive legislative competence of the Union. Steel was so declared under the Industries (Development and Regulation) Act, 1951, establishing the constitutional foundation for the Union Government's continuing role in shaping the production, pricing, distribution and trade of iron, steel and ferro-alloys. This constitutional placement is significant: it means the Ministry's authority over the sector is not a matter of administrative convenience but a deliberate national choice to treat steel as infrastructure for the entire economy rather than a conventional, state-regulated manufacturing activity.

Institutionally, the Ministry today functions as a compact but technically dense department of the Union Government, headed by a Cabinet Minister supported by a Minister of State, with a Secretary to the Government of India as the administrative head. Its mandate spans the formulation of policy on production, pricing, distribution, import and export of iron, steel and ferro-alloys; the planning and development of essential raw material linkages, including iron ore, manganese ore, dolomite, limestone and chromite; the administration of major Central Public Sector Enterprises engaged in steel and mining; and increasingly, the stewardship of the sector's transition toward low-carbon production pathways. The Ministry operates through roughly thirty functional Divisions covering board-level appointments, raw materials and logistics, technical and industrial development, green steel and climate matters, international cooperation, trade and taxation, and information technology.

The governance role the Ministry performs has evolved markedly since the early decades of planned industrialisation, when it functioned principally as the owner-operator of integrated public sector steel plants. Following the 1991 economic liberalisation, steel was delicensed and price and distribution controls were progressively dismantled, repositioning the Ministry from a command-economy administrator to a policy architect, market facilitator and custodian of strategic raw material security. This transition is still incomplete in one important respect: the Ministry continues to hold direct administrative control over several large Central Public Sector Enterprises, giving it a dual character as both regulator of the wider industry and parent department of major producers within it, a structural feature that shapes much of its engagement with private industry.

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The national significance of the Ministry's mandate extends well beyond the steel industry's own contribution to output and employment. Steel is a foundational input into virtually every other priority of the Government of India's infrastructure and manufacturing agenda, including the National Infrastructure Pipeline, the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan, defence indigenisation under Atmanirbhar Bharat, renewable energy infrastructure, urban housing, and the automotive and capital goods value chains. The Ministry's policy choices on capacity expansion, raw material security, import substitution and decarbonisation therefore propagate across the manufacturing economy in ways that few other ministries' decisions do, which is precisely why the quality and pace of execution support available to the Ministry, including from institutional partners such as CCI India, carries outsized economic consequence.

2: Historical Timeline of the Ministry

The Ministry of Steel's institutional evolution traces a deliberate arc from direct state ownership of production assets toward policy stewardship of a liberalised, increasingly private-sector-led industry, punctuated in the last five years by a second major inflection toward climate-aligned industrial policy. Understanding this arc matters for any partnership proposition, because each phase has left behind institutional habits and instruments that continue to shape how the Ministry engages external stakeholders today.

Year	Milestone and Policy Significance
1907	Establishment of Tata Iron and Steel Company at Jamshedpur, the foundation of India's modern steel industry, preceding any dedicated government department for the sector.
1951	Industries (Development and Regulation) Act enacted; steel declared an industry of national importance, anchoring the Ministry's constitutional mandate.
1973	Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL) incorporated as a holding and operating company to consolidate public sector integrated steel plants under unified management.
1991-92	Economic liberalisation; steel delicensed and price and distribution controls progressively withdrawn, shifting the Ministry's role from administrator to facilitator.
2017	National Steel Policy (NSP) 2017 notified on 8 May 2017, setting a 300 MTPA capacity and 255 MT production target for 2030-31 with per-capita consumption goals.
2021	Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Specialty Steel notified on 29 July 2021 with an outlay of Rs. 6,322 crore across five product categories.

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